Annexure I

INSTRUCTIONS FOR INSTITUTES FOR NSP 2023-24
National Fellowship and Scholarship for Higher Education of ST Students (earlier known as Top Class Scholarship Scheme)

Details of the Scheme and eligibility of the students:

1. Brief of National Fellowship and Scholarship for Higher Education of ST Students (earlier known as Top Class Scholarship Scheme):

i) National Scholarship Scheme is intended to encourage meritorious ST students to pursue courses at Graduate and Post Graduate level in Top Class Institutes identified by the Ministry in professional fields such as Management, Medicine/Science, Engineering and Technology, Humanities and Social Science etc.

ii) Student having secured admission in a full-time course in any of the 265 notified Institutions and as per the defined courses against those 265 Institutes will only be eligible to apply from that Institute for scholarship. (Enclosed List of 265 Institute List)

iii) The scholarship once awarded will continue till completion of the course tenure, subject to satisfactory performance of the student, as assessed by the institute.

iv) Any repetitions of a part or whole of the academic year by the student shall not be paid for.

v) The duration of the Course shall be treated from the year of admission into the Course, irrespective of the Selection Year for the Scholarship.

vi) Students availing this scholarship are not eligible to claim benefit of any other scholarship scheme of the Centre/ State Govt. for the same study.

In case of Fresh students:
Income Criteria: The total family income of the student to be eligible for this scholarship from all sources should not exceed Rs.6.0 lakh per annum. The family income shall be computed in the following manner: -

i. In case where both father and mother are working, the combined income of both of them from all sources shall be taken into account in computing total family income.
ii. In case any other member of the family, other than father and mother is an earning member, his or her income shall not be included in computing total family income.
iii. In case only one parent is alive, the income of that parent shall be taken into account for considering total parental income. If other sibling or family member is an earning member, their income shall not be included in computing total family income.
iv. In the case of an orphan, supported by a guardian, income criteria shall not apply.

v. In case of married candidates, the spousal income will also be added to compute total family income.

vi. In case of married candidates, the spouse income will also be added to compute total family income.

Note 1: Definition of Income - Income means gross income including income from all sources e.g. Salary, Interest Income, Income from House property, Income from Business, Agricultural income, and Income from any other Sources etc. It is clarified that Income for the purpose of scholarship is not the taxable Income as defined in Income Tax Act. The deductions and exemption available in the Income Tax Act u/s 10, Section 80 or any other section will not be available in computing gross Income under the scheme.

Note 2: Income certificate is required to be taken once only i.e. at the time of admission to courses which are continuing for more than one year. Income certificate should be for the financial year immediately preceding the selection year. For example, for the selection year 2023-24, income certificate for the financial year 2022-23(Assessment year 2023-24) is admissible. In case of salaried employees Form-16 is accepted. In case of income from other sources, income certificate issued by the designated authority of the respective State/UT is accepted.

b) **In case of Renewal students:** No fresh income certificate is required.

2. **Slots of Scholarship**: All eligible students who have taken admission on merit to the identified premier institutes, and are verified by Institute and Ministry as per the norms of the scheme are eligible to receive scholarship. There is no Institute- wise/ State wise/ stream wise ceiling of number of slots. However, students admitted in Management quota in a private Institute will not be entitled to scholarship.

3. The institutes are required to register their credentials on the National Scholarship Portal (NSP), if not already done. The URL of the NSP is http://scholarships.gov.in.

4. All Institutes are instructed to give the tab of NSP (www.scholarship.gov.in) on their Institute website along with timelines of Opening, Closing of Portal and verification of applications.

5. It is advised that the Nodal Officer of the Institute should be regular employee of the Institute. His Mobile number to be used for only one institute otherwise NSP portal will not allow to access it at Institute Level.

6. Institutes are advised to undertake proper advertisement in the campus about the opening and closing dates of application registration so that all ST students who fulfill the criteria of “National Fellowship and Scholarship Scheme for Higher Education of ST Students Scheme” can apply on NSP on time. Institutes should give proper link and instructions for NSP Portal on their official Website.

7. Please note that while verifying applications at Institute login, Institute have three options (buttons) i.e.:
    - **Verified** – By clicking on this button, the student's application may be verified.
    - **Defective** –If any student's application is not complete in any respect / manner or that it is not as per the scheme guidelines, Institute can return the application to the student by clicking this button and mention the reasons for the same in the dialog box. The student can make the necessary corrections and re-submit the application for verification by the Institute again.
    - **Rejected** – If that student is not a bonafide student of the Institute, the Institute can reject his application. By clicking on Rejected button his application is permanently Rejected. Student can't apply in any other scheme on NSP during 2023-24.

8. Institute Nodal Officer verify the correctness of details in the application form by comparing uploaded documents with original documents.

9. The Nodal Officer shall ensure that the applications are scrutinized on a regular basis in sync with the receipt of applications, so as to complete the process well in time and to enable defective applications to rectify the defects and re-submit the application, before closing of the Portal. It may be ensured that no student is put to hardship due to non-verification or delayed verification.

10. Institute Nodal Officer inform to the students that they can't apply for more than one Scholarship Scheme. Application form will be rejected if any student applies for more than one scheme.

11. Institute Nodal Officer inform to the students that NSP provide only one chance of updating bank accounts after the final submission of application (only in case when bank accounts details are not validated by PFMS). Applicants should be cautious to exercise this option, failing which the application will not be considered for scholarship.

12. Institutes MUST check that all documents of the students are as per the National Fellowship and Scholarship for Higher Education of ST Students Scheme (earlier known as Top Class Scholarship Scheme) in the following way:

    i. Institute Nodal officer check that student have to upload his photograph in the application form.

    ii. Institute Nodal Officer has to inform to the students that they have to upload all documents like Income Certificate, Caste Certificate, 12th Marksheet, Graduation Marksheet, Aadhaar, Bank Passbook, Bonafide Student certificate of the Institute etc.

    iii. Institute Nodal officer MUST inform to the students to fill the Aadhaar No mandatorily while filling the form in NSP. Payment of Scholarship will be made to the selected students using their Aadhaar No. linked Bank Account.

iv. Institute Nodal Officer inform to the the students that they should fill their name, gender, date of birth as mentioned in Aadhaar. Mobile No must be active throughout the tenure of scholarship and must be linked with Aadhaar.

v. Income Certificate: For Fresh students: Income Certificate for the F.Y preceding the year of selection by designated authority by the respective state / UT. Domicile students of Rajasthan and North East States also must upload the certificates issued and signed by Competent Authority (Certificate signed by Notary is not valid).

vi. Caste Certificate issued by the Competent Authority**.** Domicile students of Rajasthan and North East States upload the certificates issued and signed by Competent Authority. Also Please check the Community name in the caste certificate and it should be same as mentioned in the ST list of Ministry of Tribal Affairs.

vii. PLEASE CHECK COMMUNITY FOR BIHAR STUDENTS ALSO. AS PER THE SUPREME COURT ORDER STUDENTS BELONGING TO LOHRA / LOHARA COMMUNITY WILL BE TREATED AS ST.

viii. In case of Fresh students who are applying first time on NSP and who have not received scholarship earlier from this Ministry (irrespective of the course year i.e. 1, 2, 3 ,4, 5) Institute should convey to students to upload below documents:

Scanned Copy of Marksheet of Last Academic Qualification: Upload Marksheet as per criteria mentioned below:

- If student is applying as **Fresh Student** (irrespective of course year i.e. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5) and if student has not received scholarship earlier from this Ministry and if student is applying for Graduate level course then student has to upload his 12th class aggregate marksheet. **If Student is applying as Renewal Student** with previous year application id then student has to upload previous course/semester (in which student is presently studying) Marksheet attested by the Institute

- If student is applying as **Fresh Student** (irrespective of course year i.e. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5) and if student has not received scholarship earlier from this Ministry and if student is applying for Post Graduate level course then student has to upload Graduate level aggregate marksheet. **If Student is applying as Renewal Student** with previous year application id then student has to upload previous course/semester (in which student is presently studying) Marksheet attested by the Institute.

- PVTG (Particularly Vulnerable Tribe Group) Certificate (this document is Mandatory if student falls under this category) : If student comes under PVTG category (as per the PVTG list available on Ministry of Tribal Affairs Website then student have to upload this document mandatory.

ix. Bonafide Student of the institution (as per the format given by NSP in application form)

13. Institute NODAL Officer MUST VERIFY THE MARKS ENTERED IN PERCENTAGE AND MAKRSHEET UPLOADED BY THE STUDENT ON THE NSP PORTAL as per below criteria

FRESH STUDENTS: Please convey to students who are applying in NSP under **"Fresh Category" and have not received any scholarship from Ministry of Tribal Affairs irrespective of their course year (1, 2, 3, 4, 5)** they should keep a note of below points:

a) Under column Previous Class / Course Name **they should mention 12th or Graduate.**

b) Under column "Previous Passing Year" they should mention the Year of their previous course for which they are presently applying in NSP. If any student is studying in Graduate level course, they have to enter Previous Passing Year of 12th Class. If any student is studying in Post Graduate level course, they have to enter Previous Passing Year of Graduation.

c) **Under column "Previous Class %"** student should enter percentage as per below norms and **INSTITUTE NODAL OFFICER MUST VERIFY**:

i) Students who are presently studying in Graduate level course should enter 12th class aggregate marks and percentage (**Marks should be in Percentage and not in CGPA**)
ii) Students who are presently studying in Post-Graduate level course should enter their Graduation level aggregate marks and percentage (**Marks should be in Percentage and not in CGPA**)

d) Upload Marksheet as per below criteria by the student and **INSTITUTE NODAL OFFICER MUST VERIFY**:
i) If student is applying for Graduate level course then student have to upload 12th class aggregate marksheet.
ii) If student is applying for Post Graduate level course then student have to upload Graduate level aggregate marksheet.

14. Please find below the **Financial Assistance details** provided by Ministry of Tribal Affairs under "National Fellowship and Scholarship for Higher Education" (Top Class Scholarship Scheme) to ST students whose applications are verified:

Sr. No.	Component	Details	Remarks
1.	Tuition Fees and Admission fee	Full Admission fee, tuition fee and other non-refundable charges in respect of Government Institutes.	There will be a ceiling of Rs.2.50 lakhs per annum per student for private sector Institutes.
2.	Books & Stationery	@ Rs.5000/- per annum	per annum per student without bills/vouchers.
3.	Stipend	@ Rs.3000/-per month	-
4.	Computer & Accessories	Rs.45000/- (One-time assistance during the course tenure)	Computer & accessories may be Desktop/Laptop etc. (Without bills/vouchers)

NOTE: Please note as under:

i) Total amount of **Admission Fee, Tuition Fee, Other Non-Refundable fee** which is filled by the INSTITUTE Nodal Officer in the application form in NSP will be transfer in the Institute account by the Ministry **(if Institute is doing expenditure through PFMS EAT Module and Institute name is reflecting in OT-59 report of PFMS and in PFMS EAT-02 report institute expenditure, UC status is coming correct).**

ii) Total amount of **Books and Stationery, Computer & Accessories, filled by the Institute in Misc./ Other Non-Refundable Fee Column"** in NSP application form will be transfer in student's account directly by the Ministry in DBT Mode.

15. Please note there are 3 columns in which Fees can be filled by the INSTIUTE in NSP application form of the student as per the Scheme Guidelines:
    - **i) ADMISSION FEE:** Admission Fees as per Institute norms should be filled in the column "Admission fee".
    - **ii) TUITION FEE: In this column, please fill total of Tuition Fees and Other Non-Refundable Fee** as per Institute norms.
    - **iii) Misc. / Other Non-Refundable Fee:** Total of 3 Components should be filled (Books/Stationery, Computer & Accessories, Stipend)

(Computer allowance being a one-time payment, students those who have already received the payment once are not eligible for computer allowance)

16. Amendment in the Payment Process :

Payment of the Scholarship amount to ST students would be made in the following manner:

- **Component I:** The Scholarship amount payable for Computer & accessories, Books and Stationery, stipend etc. will be released to students through PFMS-Direct Benefit transfer (DBT) mode into their Aadhaar seeded bank account.
- **Component II**: The Scholarship amount payable towards Tuition fee, Admission fee and Non-Refundable fee will be released to the Institute through PFMS. In case the student has already paid the tuition fee, admission fee and non-refundable fee at the time of admission, it will be reimbursed to the student by the University in his Aadhaar seeded bank account on submission of receipt/vouchers..

17. Institute Nodal Officer should note that If amount entered in the Admission Fee, Tuition Fee, Misc./Non-Refundable Fee Column by the Institutes is not correct then in NSP application form Institute has the option to EDIT FEE, so Nodal Officer MUST FILL / EDIT the correct fee as per the scheme guidelines**. Ministry shall not be responsible for short fee entered in the application form. Institute Nodal Officer held responsible only. Recovery of any excess payment in the student's account will be made from Institutes.**

18. After the verification of applications is over, and before the release of scholarship, the Institutes have to formally send a requisition, in the official letter head, to the Ministry alongwith the list of students and scholarship payable to the Students and to the Institute, as per the format (Annexure-F) at www.tribal.nic.in/grievance

19. The Institute/Student having any query/issue related to Top Class Scholarship Scheme or NSP may put their grievance on www.tribal.nic.in/grievance.